

APEX INDUSTRIES

Employee HR Policy Manual

Version 3.0 — Effective January 2024

1. Introduction & Scope

This HR Policy Manual applies to all full-time, part-time, and contractual employees of Apex Industries. It outlines rights, responsibilities, and expectations. Policies are reviewed annually. Contact: hr@apexindustries.com | +1-800-APEX-HR.

2. Attendance & Working Hours

2.1 Standard Hours

Monday–Friday, 9 AM–6 PM (40 hrs/week). 1 hr unpaid lunch.

2.2 Flexible Working

7 AM–4 PM or 10 AM–7 PM shifts available with manager approval.

2.3 Punctuality

3+ late arrivals (>15 min) in a month triggers a formal discussion.

2.4 Absence Reporting

Notify manager + HR by 9:30 AM on first day of unplanned absence via AMS.

3. Leave Policy

Leave Type	Entitlement	Carry-Forward	Notice
Annual Leave	20 days/year	Up to 5 days	2 weeks
Sick Leave	12 days/year	None	Same day
Casual Leave	6 days/year	None	1 day prior
Maternity Leave	26 weeks (paid)	N/A	8 weeks
Paternity Leave	10 working days	N/A	2 weeks
Bereavement	5 days (immediate); 3 (extended)	N/A	ASAP
Marriage Leave	5 days (once)	N/A	2 weeks
Unpaid Leave	HR approval	N/A	30 days

3.1 Annual Leave Rules

- Accrues at 1.67 days/month from join date.
- Pre-approval in AMS required 2 weeks ahead for 3+ consecutive days.
- Carry-forward limit: 5 days. Excess is forfeited at year-end.

3.2 Sick Leave Rules

- Medical certificate required for 3+ consecutive sick days.
 - Cannot be combined with annual leave without HR approval.
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4. Remote Work (WFH) Policy

Employees who completed 6-month probation may work remotely up to 2 days/week with manager approval. No active PIP required.

4.1 Eligibility

- Core hours 10 AM–4 PM must be observed remotely.

4.2 Equipment & Security

- VPN mandatory when accessing company systems remotely.
- Personal devices require IT approval. Home network must use WPA2 minimum.

4.3 Productivity

Same performance standards as in-office. Manager may revoke WFH for underperformance.

5. Code of Conduct & Ethics

5.1 Professional Conduct

- Treat all colleagues, clients, and visitors with courtesy and respect.
- Conflicts of interest must be disclosed to HR in writing.
- Company assets are for business use only.

5.2 Anti-Harassment & Non-Discrimination

Strictly prohibits harassment or discrimination based on race, gender, religion, nationality, age, disability, sexual orientation, or any protected characteristic. Violations result in disciplinary action up to termination. Complaints: hr@apexindustries.com (confidential).

5.3 Progressive Discipline

- Step 1: Verbal warning. Step 2: Written warning.
 - Step 3: Final written warning / suspension without pay.
 - Step 4: Termination. Severe violations (fraud, violence) = immediate termination.
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6. Performance Management

Formal reviews: Mid-Year (July) and Annual Appraisal (December/January).

Rating	Description	Merit Increase
5 – Exceptional	Consistently exceeds all goals	10–15%
4 – Exceeds	Frequently exceeds goals	7–10%
3 – Meets	Consistently meets goals	4–6%
2 – Below	Partially meets goals	0–3% + PIP
1 – Unsatisfactory	Does not meet goals	0% + PIP mandatory

7. Compensation & Benefits

7.1 Salary

- Reviewed annually in January. Paid on last working day each month.

7.2 Benefits

- Health Insurance: Medical, dental, vision for employee + spouse + 2 children.
- Provident Fund / 401(k): Company matches 100% up to 5% of CTC.
- Life Insurance: 3× annual salary.
- Wellness Allowance: ■5,000 / \$100/month for gym or mental wellness.
- L&D; Budget: ■50,000 / \$600/year for job-related courses or certifications.

7.3 Expense Reimbursement

Approved business expenses reimbursed within 15 working days. Receipts mandatory.

8. IT & Data Security Policy

- Passwords: minimum 12 characters, rotated every 90 days.
 - MFA mandatory for all corporate systems.
 - No unauthorized software on company devices.
 - Customer/employee data is Confidential — external sharing needs DPO approval.
 - Report phishing to security@apexindustries.com immediately.
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9. Separation & Termination

9.1 Notice Periods

- Band 1–3 (Junior): 30 days. Band 4–5 (Mid): 45 days. Band 6+ (Senior): 60 days.
- Notice buyout possible with HR + manager approval.

9.2 Exit Process

- Complete Exit Clearance Checklist (IT, Finance, Admin, HR).
- Full & Final Settlement within 45 days of last working day.
- Experience letter + relieving letter issued within 15 days of FFS.

9.3 Company-Initiated Termination

Grounds: gross misconduct, redundancy, sustained underperformance post-PIP. Statutory severance per applicable labor laws.

10. Grievance Redressal

- HR Portal: hr.apexindustries.com/grievance
- Email: grievance@apexindustries.com (monitored by Chief HR Officer)
- Anonymous Hotline: 1-800-SPEAK-UP (24x7)

Acknowledged within 2 business days; resolved within 15 working days. Retaliation against good-faith complainants is strictly prohibited.
